Diagnostics waiting over six weeks

Outturn for September 2026 · forecast issued with data through August 2026

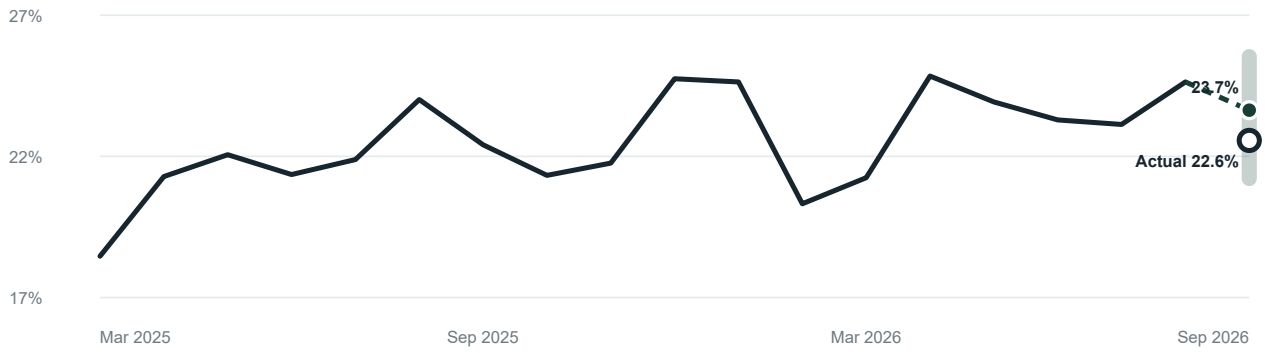
The published result was 22.6%. It improved 2.1pp from the previous result and was 1.1pp better than outlook · inside the 80% range.

AT FORECAST · AUGUST 2026	FORECAST · SEPTEMBER 2026	ACTUAL
24.7%	**23.7%**	**22.6%**
Known when the forecast was made	80% expected range 21.2%–25.6%	Improved 2.1pp from the previous result · 1.1pp better than outlook · inside the 80% range
		Off course · 14% or less by March 2027

Mar 2027 outlook at issue Projected **20.8%** Target **≤14%** Model-implied chance **7%**

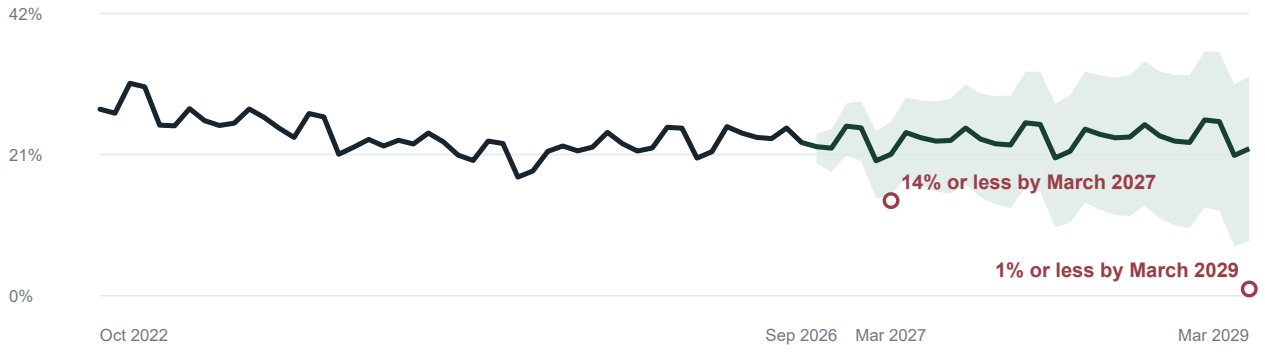
Recent performance and current release

The vertical band is the 80% expected range.



Longer-term outlook and milestones

Descriptive projection; not forced to meet targets.



Benchmark: 1% operational standard. 7.1pp above milestone

Data: NHS England diagnostic waiting times and activity. **Targets:** Medium Term Planning Framework national target · Medium Term Planning Framework final target

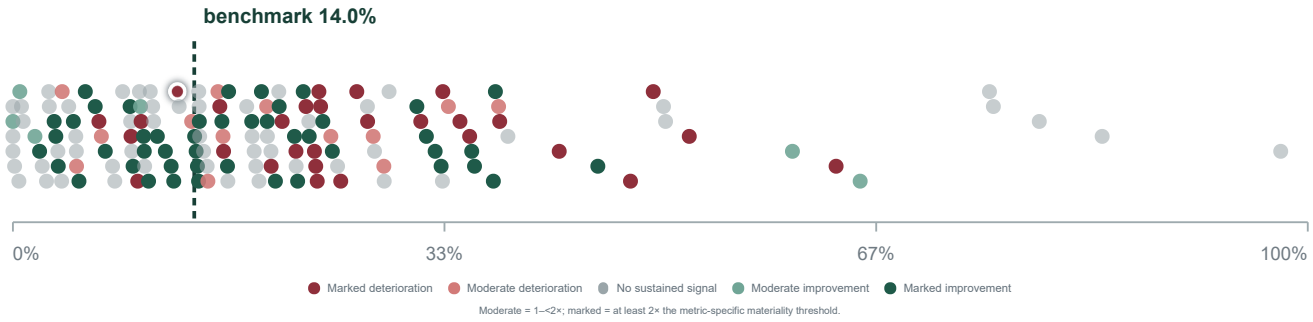
Method: Backtest-weighted ensemble of current-level seasonal movement, damped annual drift and a damped recent seasonal trend; at least 2 components are required. The final fit uses 249 consecutive months. Accuracy is tested on 36 rolling one-month-ahead forecasts. The 80% range uses empirical historical error quantiles from 36 forecast errors. Weights use inverse rolling RMSE and are shrunk toward equal weights. The pre-release commentary compares the current-level seasonal component with the combined forecast. Provider distribution and trajectory watch are shown on page 2.

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Distribution and trajectory watch · September 2026

Provider distribution

Latest reported performance across providers. This is a comparison of current levels, not a measure of whether each provider is improving or deteriorating.



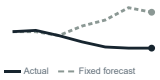
Moderate = 1–<2×; marked = at least 2× the metric-specific materiality threshold.

Trajectory watch

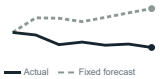
Six actual months are compared with one forecast path fixed before that window. Both lines begin at the same observed value. A low performer can be improving, while a high performer can be deteriorating. Status: Actual performance is compared with the monthly path forecast six months earlier. The displayed figure is the latest actual minus the fixed forecast for that same month; the six-month window checks persistence.

142	52	42	48
providers assessed	sustained favourable	sustained adverse	without an active signal

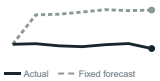
Largest sustained favourable moves

Mid Yorkshire Teaching NHS Trust
Latest 3.5% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier
Forecast fixed before the six-month window


41.2pp
LATEST MONTH: BELOW FORECAST

The Hillingdon Hospitals NHS Foundation Trust
Latest 9.0% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier
Forecast fixed before the six-month window


32.3pp
LATEST MONTH: BELOW FORECAST

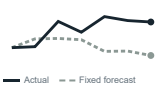
King's College Hospital NHS Foundation Trust
Latest 16.6% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier
Forecast fixed before the six-month window


25.6pp
LATEST MONTH: BELOW FORECAST

Largest sustained adverse moves

Royal Papworth Hospital NHS Foundation Trust
Latest 63.6% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier
Forecast fixed before the six-month window


46.0pp
LATEST MONTH: ABOVE FORECAST

Midlands Partnership University NHS Foundation Trust
Latest 37.6% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier
Forecast fixed before the six-month window


24.6pp
LATEST MONTH: ABOVE FORECAST

Dorset Healthcare University NHS Foundation Trust
Latest 27.4% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier
Forecast fixed before the six-month window


20.0pp
LATEST MONTH: ABOVE FORECAST

Trajectory-watch rule. Six actual months are compared with the corresponding path fixed before the six-month window. The displayed gap is the latest actual minus the fixed forecast for that same month. A signal requires a material latest-month gap and at least five of six months in that direction. These are screening prompts—not league tables, causal estimates or judgements of provider quality.